

bedlam

Inanimae suffer the same risk of Bedlam as changelings, even if they are closer to the Dreaming than their flesh-bound relatives. See p. 294 for more information about Bedlam.

Somnolence

When an inanimae has a Banality rating that exceeds her Glamour rating, she runs the risk of falling into Somnolence. For some this is a good thing, as it cleanses them and renews their spirits before waking again.

The only time an external force induced Somnolence in the inanimae was during the Shattering, when the Dreaming protected them from the ravages of Banality by casting them into Anchors and sending them into hibernation. This lasted until the mid-19th century for those who became Krofted and the mannikins, while Gladelings remained asleep until the Resurgence Glamour stirred them from their dreams.

System: Roll Glamour (difficulty of Banality + 2, maximum 9). If the roll fails, the Inanimae is slammed back to her Anchor and falls into a deep slumber. This sleep lasts for one year for every dot by which her Banality exceeds her Glamour. Once that time passes, her Banality rating drops two dots below her Glamour, and she removes all temporary Banality. If the roll is botched, or if the character's Banality rating ever reaches 10, the inanimae is Undone.

Phyla

Modern inanimae gather into kiths they refer to as phyla based on the material they choose to inhabit. Each phylum have come together in Slow Empires that work outside Kithain and human understanding, and are as important to the inanimae as the Autumn world is to changelings.

The Slow Empires

While many lesser domains exist among the inanimae, their Slow Empires divide into different categories that reflect the core nature in their aspects.

- ⑤ **Empire of Dolls** (mannikins) — mostly images carved, molded, and otherwise shaped by human hands
- ⑤ **Empire of Flames** (solimonds) — naturally-occurring ambient energy, lightning, wildfire
- ⑤ **Empire of Seeds** (kuberas) — plant life
- ⑤ **Empire of Skies** (parosemes) — gases, weather disturbances, clouds, mists, and odors
- ⑤ **Empire of Stones** (glomes) — dense solids, rocks in both raw and natural state, metals
- ⑤ **Empire of Tears** (ondines) — liquids, waterways, bodies of both standing and running water
- ⑤ **Empire of Flickers** (mannikins) — inanimae that returned from the Dreaming over the past 30 years, who anchor to conditions of artificial light, including television broadcasts, computer transmissions, and films

Glomes

heavy Folk

Do not deceive me, changeling! The stones remember your promises!

Glomes are the extremely patient philosopher-generals of the inanimae, and when enraged they bring down the full force of a mountain on their foes. Admired by trolls for their honor and dedication, inanimae of this phylum led the charge against the Solimond Empire during the Making War. Following the Evanescence, the battle drums echo throughout the Slow Empires, once more calling to them to assume their old duties and lead the battle against the darkness. Despite taking over a decade to rouse from dusty old libraries and diplomatic errands, the generals now pay attention to the threat posed by the Elder Dark and their minions.

Glomes love assembling lore, and value knowledge as much as personal honor. Though conflict exists between the Gladelings and Krofted, tensions decreased dramatically since the turn of the millennium, allowing them to come together and create the only inanimae collection of mortal history. Other phyla scoff at them for their passion of preserving the past, but the glomes know that the path to the future lies with understanding where they came from.

Anchors: Suggested Anchors for Gladelings include natural rock formations and unrefined ore. Krofted Anchors range from buildings and abstract art made from stone, to objects crafted out of metal (except cold iron, of course).

Husks: The façades of glomes often reflect their crude, natural affinity for elements pertaining to stone, resulting in bodies with much mass, be it muscle or weight. Gladelings have deep, earthy skin tones, with sharply-contoured bodies. Meanwhile, the Krofted tend to go for chiseled and marble-like appearances.

Lifestyle: Pursuing their passion for lost lore is important to the Heavy Folk, often blinding them to other duties. Like the geological progression of landmasses, the glomes are slow and overbearing, considering possible scenario outcomes before deciding on which course to take, no matter the situation. They enjoy cultivating relationships within the Kithain courts and other Slow Empires, sometimes even using gems and valuable minerals to entice others into divulging their secrets or ensure loyalty (even if glomes secretly despise dishonorable individuals).

Unleashing: Magic of the Stones brings with it the sound of boulders rolling down mountainsides, or rock edges scraping together, while tremors and cracks spread outwards from the inanimae (towards a possible target of the spell).

Sliver Affinity: Petros

BIRCHRIGHT

- ⑤ **Strength of the Stone** — Glomes gain an additional two Bruised health levels, and two dots of Strength, even if it takes the Attribute above 5.
- ⑤ **Eidetic Memory** — As the Merit (see p. 180).